Malcolm Keniston

(804) 356-5261 | mlkkeniston@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/malcolm-keniston | github.com/mlkeniston | Fairfax, VA

Education

George Mason University — Fairfax, VA
College of Engineering and Computing, Undeclared (intended: Computer Science) — *Aug. 2026 – May 2028 (Expected)*

Piedmont Virginia Community College — Charlottesville, VA
Associate of Science in Computer Science, GPA: 3.4 — *Aug. 2023 – May 2026*

- **Relevant Coursework**: Data Structures & Algorithms, OOP (Java), C++, Discrete Math, Computer Systems

Experience

Freelance Web Developer — May 2023 – Dec. 2024
Health-coaching small business (contract) — *Charlottesville, VA*

- Launched a production e-commerce site that generated **$3,000 in profit within its first 4 months** by designing and building the storefront with Node.js, Express, HTML, and CSS
- Achieved secure, always-on hosting by provisioning an AWS EC2 Linux instance, configuring Apache as a reverse proxy, and enabling HTTPS/TLS on a custom domain with IAM-scoped credentials
- Enabled online credit-card checkout for the owner's customers by integrating the PayPal REST API for order creation and payment capture
- Kept the site running for 18 months for a non-technical owner by handling all support, troubleshooting, and updates as the sole point of technical contact

Shift Manager — Mar. 2022 – Mar. 2025
Bizou Restaurant — *Charlottesville, VA*

- Kept service running smoothly in a high-volume restaurant for 3 years by running open/close procedures, coordinating front-of-house staff, and resolving customer issues on the spot
- Reduced onboarding time for new hires by training them on POS operation, service standards, and daily procedures

Cashier — Mar. 2025 – Aug. 2025
Hilltop Seafood — *Scottsville, VA*

Projects

Shonen Showdown | *Next.js, React, TypeScript, Vercel, OAuth* | shonenshowdown.dev — 2025 – Present

- Shipped a live web app where users pit two shonen anime fighters against each other and get a stat-by-stat verdict by building it in Next.js/React and deploying on Vercel under a custom domain
- Turned a static comparison into a community product by adding Google and Discord sign-in, per-matchup voting, a power-level rankings page, and a random-matchup generator
- Kept verdicts transparent by building a fighter database of curated plus AI-estimated stats and labeling the methodology in the UI

Home Lab Server | *Ubuntu Server, Samba, Plex, Docker, Networking* — 2022 – Present

- Delivered household-wide file sharing by deploying a Samba server on Linux with per-user permissions, static IPs, and scheduled backups
- Provided 24/7 media streaming for local and remote users by hosting a Plex Media Server, configuring port forwarding, and troubleshooting network and transcoding issues
- Ran a modded Minecraft server for a group of players by tuning JVM memory settings, managing mod-pack updates, and supporting users with connection problems

Discord Music Bot | *Python, Discord API, yt-dlp, FFmpeg* — 2024

- Enabled on-demand music playback in a Discord server by building a bot that fetches YouTube audio via yt-dlp and streams it to voice channels with a queue and playback commands

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Java, C++, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS, Bash
Systems & Networking: Linux (Ubuntu/Debian), Windows, macOS, SSH, DNS/DHCP, port forwarding, Samba, Apache, TLS
Cloud & Tools: AWS (EC2, CloudFront, IAM), Vercel, Docker, Git/GitHub, Node.js, Express, Next.js, React, TypeScript
Support: Hardware/software troubleshooting, end-user technical support, POS systems, customer service